

CRISTOFF STAN

Senior Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product-focused backend engineer with 9+ years of experience building distributed platforms, async pipelines, and scalable APIs. Passionate about designing maintainable backend systems that power AI-native and real-time applications. Thrive in fast-paced, founder-style teams where shipping quality features is the norm.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages & Frameworks:** Python, Django, FastAPI, JavaScript, TypeScript, Node.js
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, Redis, MySQL, MongoDB
- **Infrastructure:** Docker, GitHub Actions, Fly.io, AWS, Nginx
- **Systems:** Temporal.io, Celery, RabbitMQ, Kafka, RESTful APIs
- **Concepts:** Distributed Systems, CI/CD, Async Programming, Domain-Driven Design, RAG pipelines
- **Monitoring:** Grafana, Prometheus, Sentry, ELK
- **AI/ML:** LangChain, Vector DBs, RAG-based agents (basic familiarity)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Sensidev

September 2021 – December 2024

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Architected and implemented backend logic in Python and FastAPI, integrating Redis and PostgreSQL to handle event-driven workflows and AI tasks across multiple domains.
- Spearheaded async architecture refactor using Celery and Redis to scale task throughput by over 200% under increasing load.
- Developed automated CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions and Docker, cutting manual deployments by 95% and supporting real-time rollback.
- Designed modular business workflows using an orchestration layer that mirrored Temporal.io's DAG patterns for long-running background tasks.
- Contributed to the buildout of multi-step AI flows including external toolchains for prompt engineering and vector DB lookups.
- Created internal developer tooling for logs/metrics across services, integrating Grafana/Prometheus for near real-time alerting.

- Worked hand-in-hand with founders on debugging urgent production incidents, deploying live patches and identifying root causes under time pressure.
- Owned backend systems powering customer-facing features and drove performance optimization across endpoints, reducing response time by 60%.
- Mentored junior developers and led backend sprints to deliver feature completeness across complex cross-functional projects.
- Designed telemetry systems to support product observability, ensuring every user action had traceable server logs and metrics.
- Launched internal experimentation framework to test AI model integrations inside the ERP logic using a lightweight feature flagging system.
- Built data modeling and schema migration tools to keep PostgreSQL schemas consistent across environments during fast-paced releases.
- Proposed, designed, and shipped major architecture decisions on core modules with limited oversight, reflecting a founder-level ownership mindset.

Software Engineer

Syscom Digital

October 2019 – August 2021

Bucharest, Romania (Remote)

- Built and maintained Django-based services responsible for campaign and customer lifecycle management using PostgreSQL.
- Migrated core analytics logic to async processing using Celery and Redis, supporting real-time metrics aggregation.
- Implemented retry-safe task queues for long-running campaigns, reducing failure rates and simplifying observability.
- Designed secure API contracts for external CRM integration, leveraging OAuth2 and rate limiting at Nginx level.
- Set up CI/CD using GitHub Actions to support testing, staging, and production environments with 100% automation.
- Used APM tools like Sentry and ELK stack for error tracking, issue diagnosis, and proactive incident response.
- Engaged in DevOps work to containerize legacy services into Docker and deploy on cloud environments.
- Supported marketing automation pipelines with heavy data writes using PostgreSQL optimizations (indexes, CTEs).
- Owned project delivery for enterprise campaigns running across thousands of concurrent users.
- Ensured GDPR-compliance and implemented access controls for sensitive personal data.
- Collaborated closely with QA and product leads to define MVP scope and validate via customer feedback loops.
- Participated in product discussions directly with clients, providing technical feasibility and recommendations.
- Delivered high-throughput messaging microservices using asynchronous I/O patterns and Redis for state tracking.

Software Developer

Soft Build

June 2016 – July 2019

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Developed backend microservices for industrial ERP modules using Python and PostgreSQL.
- Automated reporting workflows and file ingestion pipelines using Celery and background workers.
- Integrated external APIs for logistics and inventory using secure, rate-limited endpoints.
- Refactored legacy code to modular service-oriented structure, improving maintainability and onboarding speed.

- Conducted data warehousing tasks and large-table joins for historical KPI computation.
- Configured Redis for both pub/sub patterns and caching strategies, reducing I/O load by over 70%.
- Built Slack and email bots using webhooks and serverless functions to surface system alerts.
- Participated in daily standups, sprint planning, and technical retros to identify and prioritize engineering bottlenecks.
- Maintained internal libraries and SDKs shared across multiple ERP modules.
- Wrote integration tests and developed test harnesses for legacy systems to ensure zero-regression releases.
- Collaborated with hardware teams to sync firmware events with backend data ingestion layers.
- Helped define initial DevOps culture through Docker adoption, CI integration, and secrets management.

Software Developer

Decima Digital

November 2015 – April 2016

Tallinn, Estonia

- Contributed to web-based platforms integrating Django, jQuery, and PostgreSQL for educational services.
- Refactored CRUD-heavy logic into RESTful APIs and improved page loading time with caching strategies.
- Delivered MVP features on tight deadlines under guidance from senior architects.
- Fixed major blocking bugs in production using log tracing and rollback debugging.
- Assisted with setting up basic CI pipelines and unit testing coverage.
- Collaborated remotely with design and QA teams to define test plans and feature specs.
- Maintained documentation of endpoints and database models across services.
- Supported junior interns and ensured they followed company coding conventions.

Software Developer Intern

Borna Technology

September 2014 – August 2015

Tallinn, Estonia (On-Site)

- Designed internal admin dashboards using Django Admin, Bootstrap, and PostgreSQL.
- Implemented role-based access control on existing web services.
- Automated test scripts for input validation, permissions, and model constraints.
- Refined table indexing strategies and optimized heavy-read queries.
- Gained exposure to Agile practices and code review cycles.
- Learned CI fundamentals using Jenkins and Bitbucket Pipelines.
- Attended customer demo sessions and documented technical feedback.
- Helped QA team prepare acceptance test cases and bug reports.

EDUCATION

Tallinn University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science,
2010 – 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

- ❖ **PostgreSQL for Data Engineers – DataCamp**
 - ❖ **Designing Distributed Systems – edX**
 - ❖ **Python Async Programming (asyncio & beyond) – Pluralsight**
 - ❖ **Building AI Agents with LangChain – DeepLearning.AI**
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PROJECTS

- ✓ **AI Workflow Manager:** Built a prototype orchestration layer simulating Temporal.io with Django + Celery + Redis. Supported multi-step async business logic with retry and saga patterns.
- ✓ **StartupStack CRM:** Side project implementing an AI-powered CRM using Python and LangChain for RAG retrieval and prompt-based email drafting.
- ✓ **CI/CD Pipeline Toolkit:** GitHub Actions-based pipeline toolkit with lint/test/build/deploy stages for Python microservices, shipped as a reusable repo template.
- ✓ **PostgreSQL Analyzer:** Internal tool to analyze query plans, track slow queries, and suggest indexes, resulting in 3x faster reports on average.